

INVESTMENT MEMORANDUM

Sổ Sạch

The AI bookkeeper on Zalo for Vietnam's 5.2 million household businesses — live product, regulatory tailwind, asking \$300k.

Why you are reading this now. On 01/01/2026 Vietnam abolished lump-sum (khoán) taxation: 5.2 million household businesses must keep books and self-declare, most for the first time in their lives. The first mandatory quarterly filing fell on 30/04/2026; the next wave of obligations (platform seller verification, Law 122/2025) lands 01/07/2026. Compliance shocks of this size create category winners. Sổ Sạch is our bid to be that winner — and unlike a deck, it is already live, in Vietnamese, at so-sach.onrender.com.

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The Forced-Demand Event

- 5.2M household businesses (hộ kinh doanh) lose the flat-tax shortcut and must record income and expenses — a population larger than all Italian partite IVA, digitising in one year.
- They are not accountants. A VCCI survey found 73% report difficulties from lack of technological knowledge; 49% worry about cost and time. The incumbent tools (MISA, KiotViet, Sapo) speak accountant; the vendor speaks Zalo.
- Zalo is the rail: ~78M monthly users, the default messaging surface of Vietnamese commerce. Sổ Sạch lives there — receipt photo in, ledger entry out, declaration pre-filled.
- Two segments, one product: street retail needs the ledger and the thresholds; online sellers (tax now withheld at source by Shopee/TikTok) need reconciliation and refund paperwork — the same engine serves both.

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The Product — Live Today

Capability	Status
Receipt photo → AI extraction → confirmed ledger entry (Claude vision; deterministic demo fallback)	LIVE
Tax thresholds engine (500M taxable / 1B e-invoice, rates per Laws 48/2024 & 109/2025) with plain-language warnings	LIVE
Pre-filled quarterly declaration 01/CNKD + print/PDF + Excel export	LIVE
Accounts (phone+PIN), household & tax-agent roles, 30-day pilot subscriptions	LIVE
Đại lý thuế (tax-agent) dashboard: invite code, client roster, per-client books & quarterly tax — the reseller channel is IN the product	LIVE
Zalo OA chat bot (webhook + signature verification)	LIVE (keys pending)
VietQR billing via payOS — code shipped, flips on with merchant keys	READY
Postgres persistence — flips on with DATABASE_URL	READY
Zalo Mini App (zero-install distribution inside Zalo)	Q3 2026

Founder execution proof: eight live products shipped solo with AI leverage in 2026 (marketplaces, SaaS, logistics routing) — this team ships in days, not quarters.

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Business Model & Unit Economics

Stream	Price	Notes
Core subscription	69,000 VND/mo (~\$2.7)	Photo ledger, thresholds, declaration draft. Priced for a street vendor — deliberately under the incumbents.
Pro	149,000 VND/mo (~\$5.9)	Multi-location, exports, e-invoice issuance via partner API.
Tax-agent channel	30% rev-share	Agents manage 20–200 clients on our dashboard; the trust channel becomes distribution.

COGS ≈ \$0.2–0.4/user/month (AI vision on ~150 receipts). Payments in VND via the founder's licensed Vietnamese entity (MoMo/ZaloPay/VietQR) — no western processor needed. Gross margin >85% at scale.

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Why Sổ Sạch Wins

- MISA gives its software away free to 2M households — and that is fine. Free generic tools still speak accountant. Our wedge is language, channel and the agent network: vendor-plain Vietnamese, inside Zalo, sold by the đại lý thuế the vendor already trusts (and pays).
- The agent dashboard is the moat. Every agent who runs 50 clients on Sổ Sạch has switching costs; every client the agent adds strengthens the channel. Software alone is copyable — a reseller network with revenue share is not.
- Compliance positioning, not 'tax optimization'. We compute the presumptive rates the law prescribes and disclaim professional advice — the defensible posture in a regulated space (and a deliberate contrast to competing pitches that promise optimisation schemes).
- Viral by artefact: every shared declaration, receipt confirmation and monthly summary carries the mark — the customer's own paperwork recruits the next customer.

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Financial Plan (Illustrative, Assumption-Led)

	Y1 (2027)	Y2 (2028)	Y3 (2029)
Subscribers (paying)	2,000	12,000	40,000
ARR	\$70k	\$450k	\$1.6M
EBITDA	–\$90k	+\$60k	+\$520k
Gross margin	85%	87%	88%

Assumptions we will defend in the room: blended ARPU ~\$3.3/mo; CAC <\$4 through agents and market-street flyers; churn 3.5%/mo year-1 falling to 2% (quarterly deadlines re-activate lapsed users). We deliberately reject the hockey-stick versions of this market (200k MAU in 18 months at \$7 ARPU against a free incumbent): our curve is channel-built, not hoped.

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The Ask

\$300,000 for 18 months of runway — SAFE or priced seed, terms open to discussion.
 Milestones: 100-household paid pilot (Q3 2026) → 2,000 subscribers + 25 active agents (mid-2027) → Series-A-ready or profitable.

Use of funds	Amount	%
Product & AI ops (Zalo Mini App, agent tooling, e-invoice API)	\$120k	40%
Agent network & field GTM (HCMC → southern provinces)	\$100k	33%
Compliance & legal (licensed tax counsel, data residency)	\$40k	13%
Buffer	\$40k	13%

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Exit Paths

- Strategic consolidation: MISA, Citigo/KiotViet, Sapo buying the micro-merchant funnel they structurally miss. SME-SaaS comparables 4–6× ARR → \$6–10M at Y3 scale.
- Fintech acquisition: a verified longitudinal ledger on tens of thousands of micro-merchants is the underwriting layer MoMo, VNPAY and banks lack for merchant cash advance and working-capital credit — the data asset is worth more than the subscriptions to the right buyer.
- VNG/Zalo itself: we build engagement and commerce data on their rail; a natural tuck-in.

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Risks, Stated Plainly

- Free incumbents: MISA's free tier could improve its UX. Our answer: the agent channel and Zalo-native workflow; we sell hand-holding, not software licenses.
- Regulatory drift: thresholds and rates move (they moved twice in 2025-26). Our tax engine is parameterised and validated with licensed tax agents before commercial claims.
- Kill criteria (we commit to them): pilot week-4 retention <25% or agents unwilling to resell at 30% → the wedge is wrong; we pivot to agent-only tooling and return remaining capital discipline to the cap table conversation.
- Platform dependence: Zalo API terms can change; the web app and agent dashboard run independently of Zalo as structural hedge.

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Diligence Process We Propose

- Meeting 1 (this memo): market, model, live demo at so-sach.onrender.com — try the agent flow yourself with a test account.
- Meeting 2: full financial model, cohort assumptions, pilot design and agent pipeline.
- Diligence: under mutual NDA — codebase walkthrough, tax-engine parameters, extraction pipeline and infrastructure access. (High-level everything is shareable; the how stays gated until the MNDA — standard hygiene, applied symmetrically.)

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Live product: so-sach.onrender.com · Business plan and demo credentials on request.

Figures marked illustrative are projections, not guarantees; tax parameters to be re-validated with a licensed đại lý thuế before commercial claims.